



E. North America

Grand Central Terminal

A majestic Beaux Arts railway terminus in New York with more than 750,000 passengers every weekday

Commuters and travelers from upstate New York and Connecticut flood into New York City via Grand Central Terminal—the largest working train station in the US and the third busiest in North America. Its 44 platforms are all underground, serving 56 different passenger tracks on two different levels with an additional 11 sidings. Two even deeper levels are currently under construction. The terminal is among the world's top 10 most visited tourist destinations, with numbers easily exceeding 22 million people each year.

The Main Concourse

The current station—the third on the site—was built in 1903–1913. Its Main Concourse, originally known as the Express Concourse because of the departing intercity trains, is deliberately vast—a huge hall 275 ft (84 m) long, 120 ft (37 m) wide, and 125 ft (38 m) high—and is intended to underline the terminal's status. Its elliptical, barrel-vaulted ceiling displays a highly decorated mural of the constellations; 10 globe-shaped chandeliers shed light on the crowds below. An 18-sided information booth in the center of the concourse is topped by a four-sided brass clock, probably the most iconic feature of the terminal.



◁ MEETING POINT

The geographical center of the station, the Main Concourse is lit by 10 chandeliers and large, arched windows. It also contains two working fountains.

△ GRAND SCULPTURE

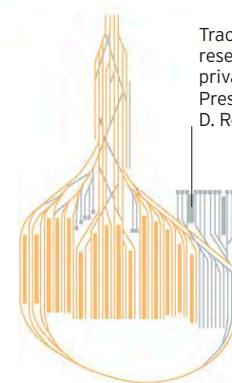
The 66-ft- (20-m-) wide *Glory of Commerce*, sculpted by French artist Jules-Félix Coutan, on the south facade of the station, features the Roman gods Minerva, Hercules, and Mercury.

TRACKS AND TERMINALS

Trains arrive at the terminal every 58 seconds, rising up a gentle slope to slow down. The train tracks are arranged on two levels, with 30 on the top level and 26 on the lower. North of the station, the tracks converge to pass under the length of Park Avenue, finally emerging at 97th Street on the Upper East Side.

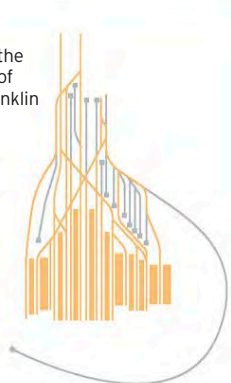
KEY

■ Main tracks ■ Sidings



UPPER LEVEL

Track 61 was reserved for the private train of President Franklin D. Roosevelt



LOWER LEVEL